

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 11

Group 11 Vocabulary

1. Abhor

Meaning: To hate something very strongly.

Tip to remember: Abhor sounds like “a horror.” If something gives you horror, you abhor it.

Sentence: Most people abhor cruelty toward animals.

2. Boisterous

Meaning: Noisy, energetic, and cheerful.

Tip to remember: Think of boys shouting and playing loudly. That loud energy is boisterous.

Sentence: The boisterous crowd cheered after the team scored.

3. Chivalrous

Meaning: Courteous, brave, and honorable, especially toward women.

Tip to remember: Think of knights in old stories. Knights were expected to be brave and polite; that is chivalrous.

Sentence: His chivalrous behavior impressed everyone at the event.

4. Churlish

Meaning: Rude, mean, or impolite.

Tip to remember: Churlish sounds like “childish,” but in a rude way. A churlish person behaves badly.

Sentence: It was churlish of him not to thank the hosts.

5. Clandestine

Meaning: Secret or hidden, often because it is improper or illegal.

Tip to remember: Think of a secret meeting behind closed doors. That meeting is clandestine.

Sentence: The spies held a clandestine meeting at night.

6. Complacent

Meaning: Too satisfied with oneself, often leading to carelessness.

Tip to remember: Think of someone saying, “I am already good enough,” and then stopping effort. That is complacent.

Sentence: The team became complacent after winning the first match.

7. **Cumbersome**
Meaning: Large, heavy, awkward, or difficult to handle.
Tip to remember: Think of carrying a huge, heavy box. It is cumbersome.
Sentence: The old machine was too cumbersome to move easily.
8. **Debilitating**
Meaning: Making someone or something weak.
Tip to remember: Debilitating sounds like “de-ability.” It removes ability or strength.
Sentence: The illness had a debilitating effect on his body.
9. **Deliberate**
Meaning: Done intentionally; or careful and slow in deciding.
Tip to remember: Deliberate has two GRE meanings: intentional and careful. A deliberate action is not accidental.
Sentence: His mistake was not accidental; it was deliberate.
10. **Droll**
Meaning: Amusing in an odd or dry way.
Tip to remember: Think of a person telling jokes with a straight face. That dry humor is droll.
Sentence: The professor’s droll comments made the lecture entertaining.
11. **Eccentric**
Meaning: Unusual, strange, or unconventional.
Tip to remember: In circles, eccentric means off-center. An eccentric person is socially off-center or unusual.
Sentence: The eccentric inventor wore different colored shoes.
12. **Fractious**
Meaning: Irritable, quarrelsome, or difficult to control.
Tip to remember: Fractious sounds like “fracture.” A fractious group easily breaks into arguments.
Sentence: The fractious students refused to follow instructions.
13. **Limpid**
Meaning: Clear, transparent, or easy to understand.
Tip to remember: Think of a clear mountain lake. Its water is limpid.
Sentence: Her limpid explanation helped everyone understand the concept.
14. **Mawkish**
Meaning: Overly emotional or sentimental in a fake or unpleasant way.
Tip to remember: Think of a movie that tries too hard to make you cry. That is mawkish.
Sentence: The speech became mawkish with too many emotional stories.
15. **Obeisance**
Meaning: A gesture of deep respect or submission.

- Tip to remember:** Obeisance sounds like “obedience.” It shows respect and submission.
- Sentence:** The followers bowed in obeisance to their leader.
16. **Ostentatious**
Meaning: Showy in an attempt to impress others.
Tip to remember: Think of someone wearing expensive clothes only to show off. That is ostentatious.
Sentence: His ostentatious lifestyle annoyed his simple friends.
17. **Panacea**
Meaning: A solution or cure for all problems.
Tip to remember: Think of a magic medicine that cures every disease. That is a panacea.
Sentence: Technology is useful, but it is not a panacea for all educational problems.
18. **Perfunctory**
Meaning: Done quickly and carelessly, only as a duty.
Tip to remember: Think of doing work just to “perform the function,” without care. That is perfunctory.
Sentence: He gave the document a perfunctory glance before signing it.
19. **Perilous**
Meaning: Dangerous or risky.
Tip to remember: Peril means danger. Perilous means full of danger.
Sentence: The climbers began a perilous journey through the snowstorm.
20. **Pervasive**
Meaning: Spreading widely throughout an area or group.
Tip to remember: Think of a smell spreading everywhere in a room. It becomes pervasive.
Sentence: Corruption was pervasive in the organization.
21. **Preclude**
Meaning: To prevent something from happening; to make impossible.
Tip to remember: “Pre” means before, and “clude” means close. Preclude means to close the door before something happens.
Sentence: Heavy rain may preclude outdoor activities.
22. **Predilection**
Meaning: A preference or special liking for something.
Tip to remember: Think of “pre-selection.” If you have already selected one option in your mind, you have a predilection for it.
Sentence: He has a predilection for research related to renewable energy.
23. **Rapacious**
Meaning: Extremely greedy or aggressively grasping.

Tip to remember: Rapacious sounds like “rapidly taking.” A rapacious person grabs more and more quickly.

Sentence: The rapacious landlord kept increasing the rent.

24. **Relish**

Meaning: To enjoy greatly; also, enjoyment or pleasure.

Tip to remember: Relish is also a tasty food topping. If you relish something, you enjoy its taste or experience.

Sentence: She relished the challenge of solving difficult problems.

25. **Satirical**

Meaning: Using humor, irony, or criticism to expose foolishness or corruption.

Tip to remember: Think of political cartoons that make fun of leaders to criticize them. They are satirical.

Sentence: The satirical article mocked the government’s poor planning.

26. **Sham**

Meaning: Something fake or false; a pretense.

Tip to remember: Sham sounds like “scam.” Both involve something fake.

Sentence: The competition was a sham because the winner had already been chosen.

27. **Skirt**

Meaning: To avoid dealing with something directly.

Tip to remember: Think of walking around the edge, or skirt, of a problem instead of facing it.

Sentence: The politician tried to skirt the difficult question.

28. **Sluggish**

Meaning: Slow, lazy, or lacking energy.

Tip to remember: Think of a slug moving slowly. Sluggish means slow like a slug.

Sentence: He felt sluggish after sleeping too late.

29. **Spartan**

Meaning: Simple, strict, and without comfort or luxury.

Tip to remember: The ancient Spartans were known for strict, simple living.

Sentence: The hostel room was spartan but clean.

30. **Truculent**

Meaning: Aggressive, hostile, and eager to fight.

Tip to remember: Truculent sounds like “truck violent.” Imagine a truck charging aggressively.

Sentence: His truculent attitude made peaceful discussion impossible.